Said Meinerding, “I think one of the things I tried to bring to the design was some sense of realism. So to try to take something that on the page reads as really great — the iconic silhouette that Jack Kirby designed — and find a way to make that fit in our world, to try and make the material feel real. To try to change the stripes on his torso into straps that would hold down his shoulder armor and hold the weight of the shield when he wore it on his back. To find ways to work it in so it doesn’t necessarily feel as costume-y as it possibly could. That was one of the more exciting challenges to me, trying to make him feel real.”

Concept art by Ryan Meinerding.